caves in bottom or uneven top are undesirable characteristics of cake.

iv) Crust-character

The term crust character applies to the condition of the crust and will vary with the type of cake. A good cake should have a thin and tender crust. Thick, rubbery, sticky or over moist, too tender, tough or blistery crusts are indicative of poor quality cakes.

v) Bloom

The term bloom refers to sheen. A good live colour with brilliance is the sigh of a good bloom.

II. Internal characteristics

i) Grain

Grain varies according to the type of cake. Uniform cell size and cell wall are desirable qualities. Coarseness, thick cell walls, uneven size of cells, large holes and tunnels indicate the poor qualities of the cake.

ii) Crumb colour

Colour of the crumb should be uniform. It should not have streaks or dark patches, grey, non-uniform dark, light or dull colour.

iii) Aroma

Aroma of the cake should be appetizing. The air in the cell structure carries the aroma. A good cake aroma should be pleasant, sweet and natural. Flat, musty, strong or sharp aromas are indicative of poor quality.

iv) Taste

Taste is a very important character. It depends on the types of raw materials used in the production of cake. Excess salt and soda will affect the taste. It should be pleasant, sweet and satisfying.

v) Texture



Plate 4.17 Cake Texture

Texture should be smooth and pliable as felt by the sense of touch. It depends on the physical condition of the crumb and the type of grain. A good texture should be soft, velvety, without weakness and it should not be crumbly. Rough, harsh, too compact, lumpy or too loose textures are not desirable.

vi) Shelf life

Keeping quality or shelf life is very important in cakes. It varies according to the type of cakes, richness, method and

DO YOU KNOW?

How to keep the cake fresh?

Refrigerate cakes with frostings or fillings containing dairy products

Keep cakes with creamy frostings under cover

Cool completely the unfrosted butter cakes, wrap in heavy-duty foil, and freeze.

Freeze frosted cakes in a tightly covered container.

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